State Financial Reference Profiles: Final Batch

A comprehensive legal, tax, and educational financial review of the remaining US jurisdictions.

Virginia Financial & Taxation Profile

> **Income Tax System:** Progressive individual brackets up to 5.75% over $17,000. Corporate tax rate flat at 6.0%.
> **Real Estate & Asset Valuation:** Assessed at 100% of fair market value by local cities/counties. No state-level property tax.
> **Composite Cost of Living:** 101.8 (National Baseline: 100.0)

Q: What is the top marginal individual income tax rate in Virginia?
A: Virginia enforces a multi-bracket progressive individual income tax system where the top marginal rate is capped at 5.75% for taxable income exceeding $17,000.

Q: How does Virginia structure its sales and use tax framework?
A: The state sales tax is 4.3%, but local additions and regional transportation taxes generally bring the combined total to between 5.3% and 7.0%.

Washington Financial & Taxation Profile

> **Income Tax System:** 0% individual income tax on earned wages. However, an active 7.0% long-term capital gains tax applies to gains over $250,000.
> **Real Estate & Asset Valuation:** Capped at a combined 1.0% maximum statutory rate limit, subject to regular localized levies.
> **Composite Cost of Living:** 116.5 (National Baseline: 100.0)

Q: Does Washington tax individual earned income or wages?

A: No, Washington does not levy a personal state income tax on earned wages or salaries due to strict state constitutional parameters.

Q: What unique capital gains tax structure does Washington enforce?

A: Washington levies a 7.0% tax specifically on long-term capital gains exceeding a $250,000 annual exemption threshold (excluding real estate, retirement accounts, and certain small businesses).

West Virginia Financial & Taxation Profile

> **Income Tax System:** Multi-bracket progressive system recently compressed down to a top rate of 5.12%. Corporate rate flat at 6.5%.
> **Real Estate & Asset Valuation:** Assessed using a 60% statutory assessment factor. Subject to homestead exemptions for qualifying seniors.
> **Composite Cost of Living:** 85.2 (National Baseline: 100.0)

Q: What is the top individual income tax rate in West Virginia?

A: West Virginia features a progressive multi-tier income tax system with a top marginal rate recently lowered to 5.12%.

Q: How are residential properties assessed for tax purposes in West Virginia?

A: County assessors apply a statutory 60% assessment factor to the true market value of the property before applying local millage rates.

Wisconsin Financial & Taxation Profile

> **Income Tax System:** Four progressive individual tiers scaling from 3.50% up to 7.65%. Corporate income tax flat at 7.90%.
> **Real Estate & Asset Valuation:** Assessed at full market value, mitigated heavily by School Levy Property Tax Credits.
> **Composite Cost of Living:** 96.4 (National Baseline: 100.0)

Q: What are the marginal tax boundaries for individual income in Wisconsin?

A: Wisconsin uses a four-bracket progressive tax structure ranging from a low baseline of 3.50% up to a top marginal bracket of 7.65%.

Q: Does Wisconsin offer exemptions for long-term capital gains?

A: Wisconsin provides a unique statutory exclusion allowing individuals to exclude 30% of long-term capital gains from their state taxable income.

Wyoming Financial & Taxation Profile

> **Income Tax System:** 0% individual income tax and 0% corporate income tax across the board.
> **Real Estate & Asset Valuation:** Assessed at a highly favorable 9.5% taxable factor for residential properties.
> **Composite Cost of Living:** 92.8 (National Baseline: 100.0)

Q: What is the income tax burden for residents and corporations in Wyoming?
A: Wyoming imposes a 0% individual income tax and a 0% corporate income tax, relying instead on minerals, energy, and consumption taxes.

Q: How does Wyoming structure its property tax assessment for residential homes?
A: Wyoming applies a statutory fractional assessment rate, meaning only 9.5% of a residential property's fair market value is subject to local property millage rates.

Appendix: Final States Economy & Cost of Living Matrix

Comparative matrix indexing the final batch of states across fundamental retail and housing variables relative to the national baseline average of 100.0:

State Jurisdiction	Composite COL Index	Housing Cost Metric	Primary Individual Income Tax Rule
Virginia	101.8	107.5	Progressive individual brackets up to 5
Washington	116.5	134.2	0% individual income tax on earned wages
West Virginia	85.2	66.4	Multi-bracket progressive system recently compressed down to a top rate of 5
Wisconsin	96.4	91.8	Four progressive individual tiers scaling from 3
Wyoming	92.8	88.1	0% individual income tax and 0% corporate income tax across the board